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Call for Submissions

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You are invited to submit an agent to the **Human-Agent Negotiation (HAN) League** of the International Automated Negotiating Agents Competition (ANAC) as part of the IJCAI 2026 official competition track.

ANAC has been running since 2010 in conjunction with AAMAS/IJCAI. The HAN league focuses on the specific challenges facing an agent negotiating with a human partner instead of another agent.

The Challenge

The participants are challenged to build a negotiation strategy that uses the alternating offers protocol (AOP) augmented with text input/output to effectively negotiate with human subjects. Strategies should be compatible with standard AOP but may use multi-modal communication to influence or inform the human negotiator.

New in 2026

- **New Platform:** The league utilizes an open-source web-based Python interface (built on Panel) called [Human Agent Negotiation Interface](#) that provides humans with utility trajectories, offer distributions, and outcome choosers to encourage rational behavior. Previous iterations of the Human-Agent Negotiation League conducted as part of ANAC 2027 - 2022 used the Java-based [IAGO Platform](#).

Negotiation Protocol

Agents act as negotiators in a bilateral setting. The protocol follows these rules: * **Alternating Offers:** Negotiators take turns making offers. On each turn, the negotiator (human or agent) can Accept, Reject (and counter), or End the negotiation. * **Multi-modal Communication:** Agents can return Markdown-formatted text to provide context or persuasion to the human user. * **Scenario:** Different scenarios will be evaluated including Procurement, Resource Distribution, etc. Evaluation scenarios can differ from the examples provided in the submission template.

Platform

The league is built on [NegMAS](#), the same platform used for all ANAC 2026 leagues. * **Development:** Please download the [template](#) and follow the installation steps in `README.md` * **API:** We provide multiple APIs that can be used to implement your agent:

- You can implement a single `__call__()` method that receives an offer (containing text and/or proposal) and responds to it with a decision (accept/reject/end) and an optional counter offer (in case of rejection) with optional text.
- You can modify the prompts used by an LLM to implement the negotiation strategy.
- You can build your agent by combining existing or new offering strategies, acceptance strategies and opponent modeling methods (**BOANegotiator**).

Submission and Live Competition

The competition runs in two stages: 1. **Offline Qualifications:** Depending on the number of participants, an initial automated round in which the participant agents negotiate against personality-adjusted verified LLM negotiators simulating human negotiators. After this optional initial round, we will conduct qualifications and finals rounds using crowd-sourced human negotiators. 2. **League Demonstration:** Run **on-site** at IJCAI 2026. Any conference participant can negotiate with the finalist agents. This will not affect agent scores but will provide useful feedback for the finalists.

Evaluation

- **Agent Evaluation:** Agents are ranked based on the utility they achieve against a variety of human subjects. We will also evaluate agents based on the perception of human partners.
- **Human Evaluation:** To incentivize serious participation, prizes are awarded to the top-performing human negotiators.
- **Fairness:** To account for human learning, we use a “best m sessions” scoring system, allowing humans to practice and improve without being penalized for early low scores.

Organizing Committee

- **Yasser Mohammad**, NEC CORPORATION (main contact)
- **Reyhan Aydogan**, Özyeğin University & Delft University of Technology
- **Rafik Hadfi**, Kyoto University

Important Dates

- **Registration on the competition website (Recommended):** April 25th, 2026
- **Preliminary submission deadline (REQUIRED):** May 25th, 2026
- **Final submission deadline:** June 1st, 2026
- **Academic Report submission deadline:** June 5th, 2026

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